Independent qualifier v4 and additive v5 source review

Result: v4 had one remaining receipt-count precision issue; additive v5 addresses it. No further blocking discrepancy was found at the amended software qualification scope. All29 v4/v5 manifest entries match. No Docker, container, gate/helper, compiler or tested payload was run during this source review. This review is not execution admission.

Metadata: nine fixed local Unix-socket HEAD requests replace the broad /opt archive. The curl route is env-i, -q, no proxy or redirect, pinned client/API and per-request timeout/output cap. The decoder requires HTTP200, exactly one PathStat header, validated base64, duplicate-key rejection, exact JSON fields, plain-directory Go mode, all traversal bits and no linkTarget. It explicitly reports UID/GID and ACL unobserved. Docker API compatibility, root basename and actual access remain runtime checks; mode-bit assertions are not a general ACL access proof.

Custody: narrow executable, recovery, build-info and smoke archives preserve exact allowlists, file/directory kind, runtime lengths, bytes, mode and ownership checks. Unrelated /opt contents are not fetched. The new readonly gate file is separately digest-bound, regular/single-link/non-symlink/mode0555, and its exact readonly bind mount and entrypoint are inspected. Fixed fixture verification, restrictive namespaces/resources, deferred client ownership, exact container identity and cleanup from v3 remain.

Pre-exec receipt: Q1–Q3 run the bound gate with the case and fresh container nonce. The first stdout line must have the exact typed schema/fields, matching case/nonce/PID/UID/GID/cgroup mapping and effective pids.max/current1; inode/ clock bounds are checked. Root's separate gate execution review confirms the exact source/binary and fixed software controls. This is observation after container startup and before the tested exec; effective_before_container_start_proved correctly remains false. Continuous enforcement or administrative changes are not claimed.

Output checks: Q1 compares the entire remaining JSON value with the frozen report. Q2/Q3 require exact exits2/125, their rejection substring and absence of diagnostic success JSON; they do not assert byte-for-byte negative output. The gate126/127 exits cannot satisfy these cases. v4 could accept a second gate receipt after the first line in negative output. v5 adds an explicit rejection of the gate's literal schema in all remaining stdout/stderr and clarifies the negative-output scope. The actual bound gate emits that exact schema spelling.

Completion requires Q0–Q4 in order, three accepted pre-exec records, unchanged gate/fixture hashes and exact removal. Existing300second total/30second cleanup/20second active-case limits remain; nine HEAD calls add work without a completion guarantee. Unknown client ownership blocks cleanup; client timeout alone is not container death. Pending final image/build/client/curl/API/staging/review bindings still prevent admission.

One operational uncertainty is retained: creating the /qualification parent for the gate file mount may produce a writable-layer diff on some daemon/image combinations. No such failure was observed here. v5 keeps strict empty diff and therefore fails closed rather than suppressing that evidence. Root can reconcile an actual failure before any amended retry.

Independent gate audit: /var/tmp/pencil-preexec-execution-independent-review-20261031-v1, manifest9a569fced80b2c10d524270d4e7d721bc2db6453f51d2f6200d0220abf1e1be7. Gate65f521d50818f593f5bc844eb26115bffd9866d4059a9ab5efee46df67d00377. v5 supervisor5dc1c3f6261bc5d8e38b7efb454058044a4658b18603553757a9c5a42419e240. Producer and earlier review packets remain unchanged.